which he had reserved copyright in anything he had written (unsurprisingly, it was his American publisher, worried about how many copies he might sell, who advised him to do so). As they appeared week by week, the chapters generated enormous debates among his readers, and prompted hundreds of letters, many of them questioning his decision to put on display the details of his personal life.

Gandhi's decision to present his personal 'experiments' in this way perturbed all conventions of Indian autobiographical writing – which invariably focused on the public exploits of the authorial hero. To appreciate the significance of this decision, a more specific sense of Gandhi's historical circumstances is helpful: one that lies somewhere between seeing him, narrowly, as the spokesman of Indian nationalist politics, and a more stratospheric view of him as a universal spiritual pilgrim. Gandhi's life encompassed one of the great transformations in Indian history – the arrival of modernity, impelled by colonialism, with its host of pressing intellectual and practical questions. For Gandhi, as for his fellow intellectuals – Aurobindo, Tagore, Nehru and, before them, Vivekananda – an insistent challenge was that of how to translate this alien world into one which was comprehensible, a world where it was possible to find one's moral bearings, and over which Indians, collectively and individually, might gain some control and even mastery.

Gandhi chose to address such questions through the practicalities of his life – his bodily comportment – as well as through constant commentary on his life and practice. *An*